

Now two years out of college, their financial situation had gotten worse along with their marriage. They had student loans to repay, in addition to their ever-present credit card debt and car payments. Martha and Rob were barely able to pay all their bills when they decided to divorce. Martha worried that the divorce would result in a drastic reduction in her income since she made much less money than Rob did. Martha first worked as an aide for a first grade class. But when the judge calculated the alimony payments she would be entitled to receive, she relaxed. These payments supplementing the income from her job would be sufficient to cover her expenses. Unfortunately, Martha's peace of mind only lasted one month.

The first alimony check did not arrive on the scheduled day. In a panic, she called her ex-husband who assured her that it was coming, he had just forgotten to put it in the mail. She called him again when days passed without the payment arriving, but this time the phone had been disconnected. Since Rob worked out of his home, she went over there to confront him in person about the payment.

To her shock, when she arrived, his apartment had been vacated. The landlord told Martha that Rob said he would call her with his forwarding address after he had relocated. She promised she would call Martha as soon as he contacted her. Martha never heard from the landlord again.

With no address for Rob, the district attorney's office could not find him to force payment. Without a known job, his wages couldn't be garnished. The district attorney's office said they were understaffed and therefore could not supply the resources to locate Rob. It was up to Martha, who, of course, had no skills as a private investigator and didn't have the money to hire one.

With unpaid bills continuing to pile up and no alimony in sight, Martha decided to take a part-time job at home during the evening to supplement the income from her full-time job.

